Theme 5 title 5 New Believer

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THE GREAT PARALLEL
A 30-Day Guide to Meeting Jesus in the Old Testament
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Why This Book Exists

When you first start following Jesus, you learn about the New Testament. You learn about His life. You learn about His death. You learn about His resurrection. You learn about His grace. You learn about His love. It is wonderful. It is life-changing. It is the good news.

But then you open the Old Testament. You read about Adam and Eve. You read about Noah and the ark. You read about Abraham and Isaac. You read about Joseph and his brothers. You read about Moses and the Red Sea. You read about David and Goliath. You read about Jonah and the big fish. You might wonder, "What do these have to do with Jesus? How do they connect to my new life?"

Here is the secret. The Old Testament is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. Every story. Every hero. Every symbol. They all run parallel to Jesus. They all point to Jesus. They all reveal Jesus.

This book is for you. You are new to the faith. You are building your foundation. Over the next 30 days, we are going to look at 30 parallels. We are going to see the Old Testament. We are going to see the New Testament. We are going to see how they run side by side. And we are going to see how they meet in Jesus.

The Value You Will Get

By the end of this book, you will not see the Old Testament as just a collection of old stories. You will see it as a gallery of parallels. You will see it as a pattern. You will see it as a blueprint. You will understand the Old Testament parallels. You will understand their meaning. You will understand why they matter today. You will have a new confidence in your faith. You will have a new love for your Bible. And you will have a new appreciation for the one who is the fulfillment of every parallel.

How to Use This Guide

This is a 30 day journey. Each day takes about 5 to 10 minutes. Read the promise. Read the proof. Read why it matters for your new life. Read the faith builder. Read the prayer. If you

are not sure how to pray, just read the words out loud. God hears honest words. He is not looking for fancy language. He is looking for your heart.

Day 01: The Parallel of Creation

The Promise (OT)
"In the beginning God created the heavens and the earth." - Genesis 1:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created everything. He created the heavens. He created the earth. He created the light. He created the land. He created the animals. He created humanity. He spoke. And it came to be. It was the first creation. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. He was with God in the beginning. Through him all things were made; without him nothing was made that has been made." - John 1:1-3

Jesus is the Word. He is the one who was there in the beginning. He is the one who created everything. The creation in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You have a new life. You might wonder where to start. You might wonder what is true. Start here. Start in the beginning. Jesus was there. He created everything. He is the foundation. Your new life is built on Him.

Faith Builder
Read Genesis 1:1 out loud. Then read John 1:1 out loud. Notice the connection. Write down one thing that stands out to you.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the beginning. Thank you for the creation. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you that He was there in the beginning. Help me to build my new life on Him. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 02: The Parallel of Light

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be light,' and there was light." - Genesis 1:3 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God spoke. And light came. It was the first command. It was the first creation. It was the first light. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the light of the world. He is the one who shines in the darkness. He is the one who dispels the void. The light in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are in the dark. You might feel like you are in a void. You might feel like you are empty. Remember the light. God spoke light into the darkness. He can speak light into your darkness. He can speak Jesus into your emptiness.

Faith Builder
Turn off the lights in your room. Sit in the dark for a moment. Then turn on a light. Notice the difference. Write down one thing you are thankful for about the light of Jesus.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the light of the world. Thank you for shining in the darkness. Thank you for dispelling the void. Thank you for bringing life. Shine your light into my heart today. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 03: The Parallel of the Sky

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be a vault between the waters to separate water from water.'" - Genesis 1:6 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the sky. He separated the water below from the water above. He made a space. He made a home for the birds. He made a home for the clouds. It was the first sky. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"He is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of God. He is the firstborn over all creation. He is the one who made the sky. He is the one who made the clouds. He is the one who made the birds. The sky is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might look at the sky and wonder. You might look at the clouds and dream. You might look at the stars and hope. Remember the sky. Remember Jesus. He made the sky. He made the clouds. He made the stars. He is the one who holds it all together.

Faith Builder
Go outside. Look at the sky. Look at the clouds. Look at the birds. Talk about how Jesus made all of it.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the sky. Thank you for the clouds. Thank you for the stars. Thank you for making the world. Help me to look up. Help me to see the parallel. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 04: The Parallel of the Land

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let the water under the sky be gathered to one place, and let dry ground appear.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the land. He gathered the water together. He made the dry ground appear. He made the mountains. He made the valleys. He made the beaches. It was the first land. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"The earth is the LORD's, and everything in it, the world, and all who live in it; for he founded it on the seas and established it on the waters." - Psalm 24:1-2

Jesus is the Lord of the earth. He is the one who made the land. He is the one who made the mountains. He is the one who made the beaches. The land is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need solid ground. You might need a firm foundation. You might need something to stand on. Remember the land. Remember Jesus. He is the solid ground. He is the firm foundation. He is the one who holds you up.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a mountain or a beach. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus made the land.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the land. Thank you for the mountains. Thank you for the beaches. Thank you for the solid ground. Help me to stand on you. Help me to see the parallel. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 05: The Parallel of Plants

The Promise (OT)

"Then God said, 'Let the land produce vegetation: seed-bearing plants and trees on the land that bear fruit with seed in it, according to their various kinds.' And it was so." - Genesis 1:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the plants. He made the grass. He made the flowers. He made the trees. He made the fruit. He made the seeds. It was the first plant. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. We are the branches. We bear fruit. He is the source of life. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. The plants are a parallel. They are a pattern. They are a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want to grow. You might want to bear fruit. You might want to be fruitful. Remember the vine. Remember Jesus. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. Remain in Him.

Faith Builder
Plant a seed in a cup. Water it. Put it in the sun. Watch it grow over the next few weeks. Talk about how Jesus makes things grow.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the plants. Thank you for the flowers. Thank you for the trees. Thank you for being the vine. Help me to remain in you. Help me to bear fruit. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 06: The Parallel of the Sun and Moon

The Promise (OT)
"And God said, 'Let there be lights in the vault of the sky to separate the day from the night, and let them serve as signs to mark sacred times, and days and years.'" - Genesis 1:14 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the sun. He made the moon. He made the stars. He made them to shine. He made them to give light. He made them to mark the days and the nights. It was the first sun. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the light of the world. Whoever follows me will never walk in darkness, but will have the light of life." - John 8:12

Jesus is the light. He is the greater light. He is the light that never sets. He is the light that never fades. The sun and moon are parallels. They are patterns. They are blueprints. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a light that never goes out. You might need a light that never fades. You might need a light that never sets. Remember the sun and moon. Remember Jesus. He is the light that never goes out. He is the light that never fades. He is the light that never sets.

Faith Builder
Go outside at night. Look at the moon. Look at the stars. Talk about how Jesus made them. Talk about how He is the light that never goes out.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the sun. Thank you for the moon. Thank you for the stars. Thank you for being the light that never goes out. Help me to walk in your light. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 07: The Parallel of Sea Creatures

The Promise (OT)
"So God created the great creatures of the sea and every living thing with which the water teems and that moves about in it, according to their kinds, and every winged bird according to its kind. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:21 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the sea creatures. He made the big fish. He made the little fish. He made the whales. He made the birds. He made them all. It was the first sea creature. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"As Jesus was walking beside the Sea of Galilee, he saw two brothers, Simon called Peter and his brother Andrew. They were casting a net into the lake, for they were fishermen. 'Come, follow me,' Jesus said, 'and I will send you out to fish for people.'" - Matthew 4:18-19

Jesus called fishermen. He called them to follow Him. He called them to fish for people. The sea creatures are parallels. They are patterns. They are blueprints. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are drowning. You might feel like you are lost at sea. Remember the fishermen. Remember the one who calmed the sea. Jesus is the one who saves. He is the one who rescues. He is the one who calls you out of the deep.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a fish. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus called the fishermen to follow Him.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the fish. Thank you for the birds. Thank you for calling the fishermen. Thank you for calling me. Help me to follow you. Help me to fish for people. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 08: The Parallel of Animals

The Promise (OT)
"And God made the wild animals according to their kinds, the livestock according to their kinds, and all the creatures that move along the ground according to their kinds. And God saw that it was good." - Genesis 1:25 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made the animals. He made the lions. He made the lambs. He made the elephants. He made the bugs. He made them all. It was the first animal. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"Look, the Lamb of God, who takes away the sin of the world!" - John 1:29

Jesus is the Lamb. He is the Lamb of God. He takes away the sin of the world. The animals are parallels. They are patterns. They are blueprints. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a sacrifice. You might need someone to take away your sin. Remember the Lamb. Remember Jesus. He is the Lamb of God. He takes away the sin of the world. He takes away your sin. He takes away your guilt. He takes away your shame.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a lamb. Write the name "Jesus" on it. Talk about how Jesus is the Lamb of God.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the Lamb of God. Thank you for taking away the sin of the world. Thank you for taking away my sin. Help me to trust in your sacrifice. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 09: The Parallel of Humanity

The Promise (OT)
"Then God said, 'Let us make mankind in our image, in our likeness, so that they may rule over the fish in the sea and the birds in the sky, over the livestock and all the wild animals, and over all the creatures that move along the ground.'" - Genesis 1:26 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created humanity. He created them in His image. He created them in His likeness. He created them to rule. He created them to have dominion. It was the first humanity. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"The Son is the image of the invisible God, the firstborn over all creation." - Colossians 1:15

Jesus is the image of God. He is the true image. He is the perfect likeness. The humanity in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you have no purpose. You might feel like you have no value. Remember the parallel. You are created in the image of God. You are created with a purpose. You are created with value. You are not an accident. You are part of the plan.

Faith Builder
Look in the mirror. Say out loud, "I am created in the image of God. I have purpose. I have value." Write it down. Put it somewhere you can see it.

The Prayer
God, thank you for creating me. Thank you for creating me in your image. Thank you for giving me purpose. Thank you for giving me value. Help me to see myself the way you see me. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 10: The Parallel of Rest

The Promise (OT)
"By the seventh day God had finished the work he had been doing; so on the seventh day he rested from all his work. Then God blessed the seventh day and made it holy, because on it he rested from all the work of creating that he had done." - Genesis 2:2-3 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God created for six days. He worked. He formed. He filled. He made. Then He rested. He stopped. He ceased. He blessed the seventh day. It was the first rest. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"Come to me, all you who are weary and burdened, and I will give you rest." - Matthew 11:28

Jesus is the rest. He is the true rest. He is the one who gives rest to the weary. The rest in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be tired. You might be weary. You might be burdened. Remember the rest. Remember Jesus. He is the one who gives rest. He is the one who

gives peace. He is the one who gives refreshment. You can stop striving. You can stop working. You can rest in Him.

Faith Builder
Take a nap. Read a book. Go for a walk. Do something restful. As you rest, thank Jesus for being your rest.

The Prayer
Jesus, I am tired. I am weary. I am burdened. Thank you for being my rest. Thank you for giving me rest. Help me to stop striving. Help me to rest in you. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 11: The Parallel of the Garden

The Promise (OT)
"Now the LORD God had planted a garden in the east, in Eden; and there he put the man he had formed. The LORD God made all kinds of trees grow out of the ground—trees that were pleasing to the eye and good for food. In the middle of the garden were the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." - Genesis 2:8-9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God planted a garden. He planted it in Eden. He put the man there. He made trees grow. Trees that were pretty. Trees that had food. In the middle of the garden was the tree of life. It was the first garden. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"Then Jesus said to them, 'Very truly I tell you, unless you eat the flesh of the Son of Man and drink his blood, you have no life in you. Whoever eats my flesh and drinks my blood has eternal life, and I will raise them up at the last day.'" - John 6:53-54

Jesus is the tree of life. He is the one who gives eternal life. The garden in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want life. You might want eternal life. You might want to eat from the tree of life. Remember the garden. Remember Jesus. He is the tree of life. He gives life. He gives eternal life. He gives himself.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a garden. Draw a tree in the middle. Write the name "Jesus" on the tree. Talk about how Jesus is the tree of life.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the tree of life. Thank you for giving me life. Thank you for giving me eternal life. Help me to eat from your tree. Help me to feed on your truth. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 12: The Parallel of the River

The Promise (OT)
"A river watering the garden flowed from Eden; from there it was separated into four headwaters." - Genesis 2:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

A river flowed from Eden. It watered the garden. It brought life. It brought refreshment. It brought blessing. It was the first river. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"Whoever believes in me, as Scripture has said, rivers of living water will flow from within them. By this he meant the Spirit, whom those who believed in him were later to receive." - John 7:38-39

Jesus is the river of living water. He is the source of life. He is the source of refreshment. He is the source of blessing. The river in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be thirsty. You might be dry. You might be empty. Remember the river. Remember Jesus. He is the river of living water. He can quench your thirst. He can refresh your soul. He can fill your emptiness.

Faith Builder
Drink a glass of water. As you drink it, thank Jesus for being the living water. Thank Him for refreshing your soul.

The Prayer
Jesus, you are the river of living water. Thank you for quenching my thirst. Thank you for refreshing my soul. Thank you for filling my emptiness. Help me to drink from your river. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 13: The Parallel of the Command

The Promise (OT)
"And the LORD God commanded the man, 'You are free to eat from any tree in the garden; but you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil, for when you eat from it you will certainly die.'" - Genesis 2:16-17 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God gave a command. He gave a rule. He gave a test. He said, "You are free to eat from any tree. But you must not eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil." It was the first command. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)

"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam disobeyed. He broke the command. He ate the fruit. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus obeyed. He kept the command. He never sinned. He brought righteousness into the world. The command in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are always breaking the rules. You might feel like you are always failing. You might feel like you are always disobeying. Remember Jesus. He obeyed for you. He kept the command for you. He brought righteousness for you.

Faith Builder
Think of a rule you struggle to keep. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus kept this rule for me." Thank Him for His obedience.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for obeying. Thank you for keeping the command. Thank you for bringing righteousness. Thank you for taking my disobedience. Help me to live in your obedience. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 14: The Parallel of the Helper

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God said, 'It is not good for the man to be alone. I will make a helper suitable for him.'" - Genesis 2:18 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God said, "It is not good for the man to be alone." He made a helper. He made a companion. He made Eve. It was the first helper. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"And I will ask the Father, and he will give you another advocate to help you and be with you forever—the Spirit of truth." - John 14:16-17

Jesus promised a helper. He promised the Holy Spirit. He promised an advocate. He promised a companion. The helper in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is the Holy Spirit.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be lonely. You might be alone. You might need help. Remember the helper. Remember the Holy Spirit. He is with you. He is your advocate. He is your companion. You are not alone.

Faith Builder

Write down one thing you need help with. Pray and ask the Holy Spirit to help you. Thank Him for being your helper.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the helper. Thank you for the Holy Spirit. Thank you for being with me. Thank you for being my advocate. Thank you for being my companion. Help me to know the Spirit. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 15: The Parallel of the Rib

The Promise (OT)
"But for Adam no suitable helper was found. So the LORD God caused the man to fall into a deep sleep; and while he was sleeping, he took one of the man's ribs and then closed up the place with flesh. Then the LORD God made a woman from the rib he had taken out of the man, and he brought her to the man." - Genesis 2:20-22 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God caused Adam to fall asleep. He took a rib. He made a woman. He brought her to the man. It was the first rib. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"For we are members of his body. 'For this reason a man will leave his father and mother and be united to his wife, and the two will become one flesh.' This is a profound mystery—but I am talking about Christ and the church." - Ephesians 5:30-32

Paul says the story of Adam and Eve is a mystery. It is about Christ and the church. Jesus slept in death. He took a wound in his side. He created the church. The rib in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel like you are a part of something. You might feel like you belong. Remember the rib. Remember the church. You are part of the body of Christ. You are created from his side. You belong to him.

Faith Builder
Think about your church family. Write down one person who makes you feel like you belong. Thank God for them.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the church. Thank you for creating the church. Thank you for the wound in your side. Thank you for making me part of your body. Help me to love the church. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 16: The Parallel of the Serpent

The Promise (OT)
"Now the serpent was more crafty than any of the wild animals the LORD God had made. He said to the woman, 'Did God really say, "You must not eat from any tree in the garden"?'" - Genesis 3:1 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The serpent was crafty. He was sneaky. He was deceptive. He questioned God's word. He questioned God's goodness. He twisted the truth. He tempted the woman. It was the first serpent. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"The great dragon was hurled down—that ancient serpent called the devil, or Satan, who leads the whole world astray." - Revelation 12:9

The serpent in Genesis is the devil. He is Satan. He is the ancient serpent. He is the one who leads the world astray. But Jesus defeated him. Jesus crushed his head. The serpent is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be tempted. You might be deceived. You might be lied to. Remember the serpent. Remember the defeat. Jesus crushed his head. He defeated him. He won the victory. You are on the winning side.

Faith Builder
Think of a lie you have believed about yourself. Write it down. Then write down a truth from God's word that replaces it. Say the truth out loud.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for defeating the serpent. Thank you for crushing his head. Thank you for winning the victory. Help me to resist temptation. Help me to see through the lies. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 17: The Parallel of the Fall

The Promise (OT)
"When the woman saw that the fruit of the tree was good for food and pleasing to the eye, and also desirable for gaining wisdom, she took some and ate it. She also gave some to her husband, who was with her, and he ate it." - Genesis 3:6 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The woman saw the fruit. She saw it was good. She saw it was pleasing. She saw it was desirable. She took it. She ate it. She gave it to her husband. He ate it. It was the first fall. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"For just as through the disobedience of the one man the many were made sinners, so also through the obedience of the one man the many will be made righteous." - Romans 5:19

Adam fell. He disobeyed. He brought sin into the world. But Jesus did not fall. He obeyed. He brought righteousness into the world. The fall is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have fallen. You might have sinned. You might have made a mistake. Remember Jesus. He did not fall. He stood. He stood for you. He took your fall. He took your sin. He took your mistake. He gives you his standing.

Faith Builder
Think of a mistake you have made. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus took my mistake. He gives me his standing." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for standing. Thank you for not falling. Thank you for taking my fall. Thank you for taking my sin. Thank you for taking my mistake. Help me to stand in you. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 18: The Parallel of the Fig Leaves

The Promise (OT)
"Then the eyes of both of them were opened, and they realized they were naked; so they sewed fig leaves together and made coverings for themselves." - Genesis 3:7 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Adam and Eve ate the fruit. Their eyes were opened. They realized they were naked. They were ashamed. They were afraid. So they sewed fig leaves together. They made coverings for themselves. It was the first fig leaf. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the true covering. He is the true clothing. He covers our shame. He covers our sin. He covers our nakedness. The fig leaves are a parallel. They are a pattern. They are a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to cover your shame. You might be trying to hide your mistakes. You might be trying to fix yourself. Remember the fig leaves. They do not work. Remember Jesus. He is the true covering. He covers your shame. He covers your sin. He covers your nakedness.

Faith Builder
Think of a shame you are carrying. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus covers my shame." Crumple up the paper. Throw it away. Thank Jesus for His covering.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for covering me. Thank you for clothing me. Thank you for taking away my shame. Thank you for taking away my sin. Help me to stop sewing fig leaves. Help me to rest in your covering. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 19: The Parallel of the Question

The Promise (OT)
"But the LORD God called to the man, 'Where are you?'" - Genesis 3:9 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God called to Adam. He said, "Where are you?" It was a question. It was a search. It was a pursuit. God was looking for Adam. He was seeking him. It was the first question. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"For the Son of Man came to seek and to save the lost." - Luke 19:10

Jesus is the seeker. He is the one who comes looking. He is the one who calls. He is the one who saves. The question in Genesis is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be hiding. You might be running. You might be lost. Where are you? Remember the question. Remember the seeker. Jesus is looking for you. He is calling you. He is pursuing you. You can stop hiding. You can come out.

Faith Builder
Find a quiet place. Sit down. Close your eyes. Ask God, "Where are you?" Then listen. Write down what you sense He is saying to you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for seeking me. Thank you for finding me. Thank you for saving me. Help me to stop hiding. Help me to come out. Help me to answer your call. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 20: The Parallel of the Promise

The Promise (OT)
"And I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and hers; he will crush your head, and you will strike his heel." - Genesis 3:15 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God spoke to the serpent. He spoke to the devil. He said, "I will put enmity between you and the woman. Between your offspring and hers. He will crush your head. You will strike his heel." It was the first promise. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"But when the set time had fully come, God sent his Son, born of a woman, born under the law..." - Galatians 4:4

Jesus is the offspring. He is the one born of a woman. He is the one who crushed the serpent's head. He is the one who defeated the devil. The promise is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the deliverer. He crushes the serpent's head. He defeats the devil. He gives you hope.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from God that you are holding onto. Say it out loud. Thank God for keeping His promises.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Thank you for crushing the serpent's head. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 21: The Parallel of the Sacrifice

The Promise (OT)
*"The LORD God

…..

Day 21: The Parallel of the Sacrifice (Continued)

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD God made garments of skin for Adam and his wife and clothed them." - Genesis 3:21 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made garments of skin. He made clothes. He made a covering. An animal had to die. Blood had to be shed. It was the first sacrifice. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"For all of you who were baptized into Christ have clothed yourselves with Christ." - Galatians 3:27

Jesus is the garment. He is the sacrifice. He is the covering. His blood was shed. His life was given. The first sacrifice is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covering. You might need a garment. You might need a gift. Remember the sacrifice. Remember Jesus. He is the covering. He is the garment. He is the gift. He covers your shame. He covers your sin.

Faith Builder
Put on a favorite piece of clothing. As you put it on, thank Jesus for covering you with His righteousness. Thank Him for the gift of salvation.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the garment. Thank you for the covering. Thank you for the gift. Thank you for shedding your blood. Thank you for giving your life. Help me to wear your garment. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 22: The Parallel of the Exile

The Promise (OT)
"So the LORD God banished him from the Garden of Eden to work the ground from which he had been taken." - Genesis 3:23 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God banished Adam from the garden. He sent him away. He exiled him. He drove him out. It was the first exile. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"Therefore, since we have been justified through faith, we have peace with God through our Lord Jesus Christ, through whom we have gained access by faith into this grace in which we now stand." - Romans 5:1-2

Jesus brings us back. He restores our access. He brings us into grace. He brings us into peace. The exile is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel exiled. You might feel banished. You might feel separated. Remember Jesus. He brings you back. He restores your access. He brings you into grace. He brings you into peace.

Faith Builder
Think of a time you felt far from God. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus brings me back." Thank Him for restoring your access to God.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for bringing me back. Thank you for restoring my access. Thank you for bringing me into grace. Thank you for bringing me into peace. Help me to live in your presence. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 23: The Parallel of the Cherubim

The Promise (OT)
"After he drove the man out, he placed on the east side of the Garden of Eden cherubim and a flaming sword flashing back and forth to guard the way to the tree of life." - Genesis 3:24 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God placed cherubim at the garden. They were angels. They were guards. They had a flaming sword. They guarded the way to the tree of life. It was the first cherubim. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"And when Jesus had cried out again in a loud voice, he gave up his spirit. At that moment the curtain of the temple was torn in two from top to bottom." - Matthew 27:50-51

Jesus removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. He made access to God. The cherubim are a parallel. They are a pattern. They are a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might feel separated from God. You might feel like there is a barrier. You might feel like there is a flaming sword. Remember Jesus. He removed the barrier. He tore the curtain. He opened the way. You can come to God now.

Faith Builder
Draw a picture of a curtain. Then draw a line through it, tearing it in two. Write the word "Jesus" on the tear. Thank Him for opening the way to God.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for opening the way. Thank you for removing the barrier. Thank you for tearing the curtain. Help me to come to God. Help me to approach the throne of grace. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 24: The Parallel of Cain and Abel

The Promise (OT)
"Now Cain said to his brother Abel, 'Let's go out to the field.' While they were in the field, Cain attacked his brother Abel and killed him." - Genesis 4:8 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Cain was jealous. He was angry. He killed his brother. He shed innocent blood. It was the first murder. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"You belong to your father, the devil, and you want to carry out your father's desires. He was a murderer from the beginning, not holding to the truth, for there is no truth in him." - John 8:44

Cain belonged to the devil. He was a murderer. But Jesus is different. He is the innocent one. He is the one who was killed. He is the one who shed his blood. The murder is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might have been hurt by someone. You might have been betrayed. You might have been wounded. Remember Jesus. He was hurt. He was betrayed. He was wounded. He understands. He heals.

Faith Builder
Think of someone who has hurt you. Write their name down. Then pray for them. Ask God to help you forgive them, just as Jesus forgave you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for understanding my pain. Thank you for being wounded for me. Thank you for being betrayed for me. Heal my wounds. Heal my pain. Heal my heart. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 25: The Parallel of the Blood

The Promise (OT)
"The LORD said, 'What have you done? Listen! Your brother's blood cries out to me from the ground.'" - Genesis 4:10 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Abel's blood cried out. It cried out for justice. It cried out for vengeance. It cried out from the ground. It was the first blood. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"To Jesus the mediator of a new covenant, and to the sprinkled blood that speaks a better word than the blood of Abel." - Hebrews 12:24

Jesus' blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy. The blood of Abel is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need forgiveness. You might need grace. You might need mercy. Remember the blood. Remember Jesus. His blood speaks a better word. It speaks forgiveness. It speaks grace. It speaks mercy.

Faith Builder

Think of a sin you are struggling with. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus' blood speaks forgiveness over me." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for your blood. Thank you for speaking a better word. Thank you for forgiveness. Thank you for grace. Thank you for mercy. Help me to receive your forgiveness. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 26: The Parallel of the Seed

The Promise (OT)
"Noah, a man of the soil, proceeded to plant a vineyard." - Genesis 9:20 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

Noah planted a vineyard. He planted a seed. He planted a crop. He planted a future. It was a new beginning. It was a new start. It was the first seed. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"I am the vine; you are the branches. If you remain in me and I in you, you will bear much fruit; apart from me you can do nothing." - John 15:5

Jesus is the vine. We are the branches. We bear fruit. The seed is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might want to bear fruit. You might want to grow. You might want to be productive. Remember the vine. Remember Jesus. He is the source of growth. He is the source of fruit. Remain in him.

Faith Builder
Think of one way you want to grow in your new life. Write it down. Ask Jesus to help you grow. Thank Him for being the vine.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for being the vine. Thank you for being the source of growth. Thank you for being the source of fruit. Help me to remain in you. Help me to bear much fruit. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 27: The Parallel of the Covenant

The Promise (OT)
"I establish my covenant with you: Never again will all life be destroyed by the waters of a flood; never again will there be a flood to destroy the earth." - Genesis 9:11 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God made a covenant with Noah. He made a promise. He made an agreement. He said, "Never again will all life be destroyed by a flood." It was the first covenant. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"In the same way, after the supper he took the cup, saying, 'This cup is the new covenant in my blood, which is poured out for you.'" - Luke 22:20

Jesus made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He said, "This cup is the new covenant in my blood." The covenant with Noah is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a covenant. You might need a promise. You might need an agreement. Remember the covenant. Remember Jesus. He made a new covenant. He made a new promise. He made a new agreement. He made it with you.

Faith Builder
Write down one promise from the new covenant. For example, "My sins are forgiven." Say it out loud. Thank Jesus for making a new covenant with you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the new covenant. Thank you for the new promise. Thank you for the new agreement. Thank you for your blood. Thank you for your sacrifice. Help me to live in the new covenant. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 28: The Parallel of the Rainbow

The Promise (OT)
"I have set my rainbow in the clouds, and it will be the sign of the covenant between me and the earth." - Genesis 9:13 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

God set a rainbow in the clouds. It was a sign. It was a promise. It was a reminder. It was a covenant. It was the first rainbow. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"And I saw the dead, great and small, standing before the throne, and books were opened. Another book was opened, which is the book of life. The dead were judged according to what they had done as recorded in the books." - Revelation 20:12

Jesus is the one who opens the book of life. He is the one who judges. He is the one who saves. The rainbow is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life

You are new to the faith. You might need a sign. You might need a promise. You might need a reminder. Remember the rainbow. Remember Jesus. He is the sign. He is the promise. He is the reminder. He is the one who saves.

Faith Builder
Draw a rainbow. Write the word "Promise" under it. Thank God for keeping His promises to you.

The Prayer
Jesus, thank you for the rainbow. Thank you for the sign. Thank you for the promise. Thank you for the reminder. Help me to see the rainbow. Help me to remember your promise. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 29: The Parallel of the Tower

The Promise (OT)
"Then they said, 'Come, let us build ourselves a city, with a tower that reaches to the heavens, so that we may make a name for ourselves; otherwise we will be scattered over the face of the whole earth.'" - Genesis 11:4 (Written around 1400 B.C.)

The people built a tower. They built it with bricks. They built it with mortar. They built it to reach heaven. They built it to make a name for themselves. It was the first tower. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"For this reason God highly exalted him and gave him the name that is above every name, so that at the name of Jesus every knee should bow, in heaven and on earth and under the earth." - Philippians 2:9-10

Jesus made a name for himself. He did not build a tower. He did not reach heaven. He came down from heaven. He made a name for himself. He made a name that is above every name. The tower is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might be trying to make a name for yourself. You might be trying to reach heaven. You might be trying to build a tower. Remember Jesus. He came down. He made a name. He made a name that is above every name. You do not have to build a tower. You do not have to reach heaven. You can just trust Jesus.

Faith Builder
Think of a way you have tried to earn God's love. Write it down. Then write down this truth: "Jesus already made a name for me. I can rest in Him." Thank Him for His grace.

The Prayer

Jesus, thank you for making a name. Thank you for making a name that is above every name. Thank you for coming down. Thank you for reaching me. Help me to stop building towers. Help me to trust your name. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

Day 30: The Parallel of the Promise to Abraham

The Promise (OT)
"I will make you into a great nation, and I will bless you; I will make your name great, and you will be a blessing. I will bless those who bless you, and whoever curses you I will curse; and all peoples on earth will be blessed through you." - Genesis 12:2-3 (Written around 2000 B.C.)

God made a promise to Abraham. He said, "I will make you into a great nation. I will bless you. I will make your name great. All peoples on earth will be blessed through you." It was the first promise to Abraham. It was the first parallel.

The Proof (NT)
"This is the genealogy of Jesus the Messiah the son of David, the son of Abraham..." - Matthew 1:1

Jesus is the fulfillment of the promise. He is the descendant of Abraham. He is the one who blesses the whole world. The promise to Abraham is a parallel. It is a pattern. It is a blueprint. The reality is Jesus.

Why It Matters For Your New Life
You are new to the faith. You might need a promise. You might need a hope. You might need a future. Remember the promise. Remember Jesus. He is the fulfillment. He is the hope. He is the future. He is the blessing.

Faith Builder
Think about your family. Write down one way you can be a blessing to them this week. Ask God to help you do it.

The Prayer
God, thank you for the promise. Thank you for the hope. Thank you for the future. Thank you for Jesus. Help me to live in the promise. Help me to live in the hope. Help me to live in the future. Help me to follow the reality. Amen.

END MATTER

The 30-Day Parallel Challenge
You have journeyed through 30 parallels. You have seen the patterns. You have seen the blueprints. Now what? I challenge you to read the Gospel of John. It is 21 chapters. It will

show you how Jesus is the fulfillment of every parallel. As you read, look for the parallel. Look for the pattern. Look for Jesus.

A Note on Faith
The parallels are evidence. They are evidence of a divine plan. But evidence does not save you. The parallels point to a person. The parallels point to Jesus. You can understand the parallels and still miss the Savior. The invitation is for your heart. Jesus said, "Here I am! I stand at the door and knock. If anyone hears my voice and opens the door, I will come in." The parallels are on the table. The door is open. It is your choice.

About the Author
[Author Name] loves helping new believers build a strong foundation. He believes that faith is not a blind leap. It is a confident step based on evidence. He lives with his family and enjoys hiking and reading.

Coming Next: The Divine Blueprint for Kids
If you have children, the next series is for them. The Divine Blueprint for Kids takes the same 30 truths and turns them into a fun, interactive adventure. It includes family activities, coloring pages, and simple prayers.

Final Call to Action
Scan the QR code below to get the next book in the series. Visit our website to download a free reading plan. Join our community of believers. The journey is not over. The adventure is just beginning.

Cover Design Concept (The New Believer Edition)

A soft, warm cream or light parchment background. A large, glowing scroll sits in the center. On the scroll, two parallel lines are drawn in gold. One line represents the Old Testament. One line represents the New Testament. They run side by side. They meet at a cross in the center. The title THE GREAT PARALLEL is in a strong, trustworthy, bold serif font. The subtitle is in a gentle, welcoming sans-serif. The overall feel is warm, inviting, and full of hope.